Implementation Guidance: Hurdle Requirements

A hurdle requirement is an assessment requirement identified in the course profile that must be satisfied to receive a specific grade (UQ Assessment Procedure). This guidance applies to courses where the use of a hurdle for an assessment has been approved through the relevant school approval processes.

Communicating to students

Students need to be informed early and consistently about a hurdle requirement, including:

- the purpose of the hurdle requirement ('the why'),
- what they need to do to meet the hurdle requirement,
- the consequences of not meeting the hurdle requirement, and
- any available second-chance or supplementary opportunities.

The following is an example communication strategy to explain a task's secure assessment hurdle to students. This information would be communicated in multiple places (e.g., task description, assessment guidelines/helper, BB announcements, lecture slides, in-class activities) and multiple formats (e.g., written, oral, assessment video).

Example communication to explain a secure assessment hurdle to students

Example Task: Business Proposal, with compulsory panel discussion (task and course hurdle)
Example LOs: Apply management theories and research to analyse a business problem; Justify solutions or recommendations that address a business problem and integrate stakeholder perspectives.

The Business Proposal is a secure assessment task that incorporates a **compulsory, in-person panel discussion** to verify you have achieved the learning outcome associated with this task. You will be well prepared for this panel discussion if you can demonstrate your engagement with relevant management theory to develop your business proposal and can justify the ideas proposed.

NOTE: The panel discussion is designed to confirm your learning, not catch you out.

Why a secure assessment hurdle? The learnings associated with this task have been identified as integral to your [course/degree] studies, directly aligned with [course/program] learning outcomes. The hurdle is being used to ensure this learning occurred.

How does the hurdle work? With reference to your criteria sheet [rubric], you must receive a Pass for the panel discussion to be eligible to pass this assessment task AND be eligible to receive a grade of 4 or more for this course.

What if I pass the hurdle? If you receive a Pass for the panel discussion, your result for the Business Proposal will be confirmed and awarded to you. This result will then be combined with your other assessment results this semester to determine your overall course grade.

What if I fail the hurdle? You will be given a second chance, i.e., you will be invited to participate in another compulsory in-person discussion, this time with one member of the course teaching team. The purpose of this discussion is to provide you with a second chance to verify your thinking/ideas and demonstrate you have achieved the learning outcome. If you receive a Pass for the second chance hurdle, you will be awarded 50% of the available marks/weighting for this task (e.g., 20/40).

What if I fail the second chance hurdle? The highest course grade you can be awarded is a 3.

Example task sheet communication: Business Proposal (Course hurdle) Task sheet and rubric

Preparing students

Students must be provided with opportunities throughout the course, and where appropriate across the program, to prepare for hurdle requirements. While scaffolding learning is good teaching practice generally, it is particularly important when a hurdle requirement is used. Students should have opportunities throughout the course to understand what is required, practise the knowledge and skills being assessed, receive feedback on their progress, and become familiar with the assessment format and conditions.

Example preparation activities and resources

Purpose	Activities and resources
Standards and expectations	In addition to clear communication… • In-class 'rubric jam' activity where students apply the rubric to a sample response (or extract). • Explicitly discuss the rubric and what is and is not being assessed (e.g., content knowledge and reasoning rather than presentation skills). • Provide annotated exemplars (e.g., Legal Memorandum). • Share sample responses with rubric ratings and feedback. • Discuss common reasons students may not meet the hurdle requirement and strategies to address those. • Provide opportunities for students to ask questions and clarify expectations at multiple timepoints.
Practice	• Facilitate in-class practice assessments. • Low-stakes scaffolded assessment activities that mirror the hurdle requirements. • In-class or online simulations (e.g., Interviewing and Counselling ChatBot). • Provide practice questions, cases or scenarios.
Feedback	• Incorporate structured peer review activities aligned with the rubric. • Facilitate class debriefs following practice activities. • Provide group or individual feedback following practice activities or draft submissions.
Familiarity	• Share photos, videos or virtual tours of the assessment space if it differs from the usual learning environment. • Demonstrate any software or platforms that will be used. • Explain assessment logistics, including timing, procedures and expectations on the day. • Share sample videos or exemplars (e.g., IOA examples).

Support

If you require further advice or support in implementing a hurdle requirement, please contact the BEL Education Team (Chloe Salisbury) or your school learning design team.